

Sun, Mar 29 at 10:51 AM



How does this look for a clearance rescue?

Thought for a couple of seconds >

Pretty decent rescue candidate, honestly.

What looks good:

- Leaves are mostly firm, green, and still fairly full.
- Crown looks intact.
- It still has unopened buds, which means it was not too far gone when you got it.
- I do not see obvious severe sunburn or total collapse.

What looks rough:

- Several flowers are spent or drying up.
- It looks a bit dehydrated or stressed from store conditions.
- Medium looks compact and a little tired.

My take: this looks like a **good cosmetic rescue, not a near-death rescue**. The blooms may continue fading or bud blast after the move, but the plant itself looks very saveable.

What I would do next:

- Leave it in bright indirect light, not harsh midday sun.
- Water thoroughly only when the roots/media are close to dry, then drain fully.
- Do not repot immediately if it is still in bloom unless the medium is clearly rotten.
- After blooming finishes, trim the spike if it declines and then assess roots for a repot into fresh orchid bark if needed.

If this were on a clearance rack, I would call it a solid buy if the price was good. The real test will be roots. If you want, send a closer photo of the pot/root area and I'll tell you whether I'd keep it as-is or repot soon.



Here is another candidate

Thought for a second >

This one also looks like a **very viable rescue**, maybe even a little better structurally than the first.

What I like:

- Leaves are thick, green, and fairly firm.
- Crown appears clean and centered.
- I can see at least one silvery aerial root, which is a good sign.
- It looks more like an orchid with **spent blooms** than an orchid with serious plant decline.

What I do not like:

- Flowers are clearly done and collapsing.
- It is in that typical dense Costa Farms plug/setup, so the inner root zone may be wetter or more deteriorated than it looks from above.
- The lowest leaf on the left looks a little droopy, but not alarming.

My verdict:

- **Good rescue candidate**
- Better described as **post-bloom clearance** than true emergency rescue
- Worth buying at clearance price, especially if discounted well below full price

Between the two, I would probably pick **this one** if:

- the leaves feel firmer in person
- the pot does not smell swampy
- you can see any green or silvery roots through drainage holes or near the top

Quick store check before buying:

- Gently lift the inner pot if possible and sniff the medium. Sour/swampy smell is bad.
- Avoid one with a mushy crown or leaves that wobble from the center.
- A few dead flowers are fine. A dying crown is not.
- If the discount is only tiny, I would pass. If it is marked down nicely, this is a solid gamble.

At \$10.98 full sticker, I would only want it if clearance knocked it down enough. As a rescue, this looks promising.

Looks like it has good roots, it's dry not swampy. It's \$5

Sun, Mar 29 at 12:29 PM



Ok, it's home. What should I do with it today?

Here's Bungalow bill with dead flowers removed and watered. The date is 3/29/2026

Thu, Apr 2 at 3:57 PM

Should I go ahead and remove the spike that has dropped all its flowers?

Sat, Apr 4 at 7:25 AM

Ready to repot. He does have a plug



After root trim?



Repotted

Wed, Apr 15 at 7:07 AM



4/15



Sun, Jun 28 at 6:24 PM



6/28/06

Thought for 5s >

Yes, I agree.

That inner/newest leaf does look noticeably better than the older outer leaves. It looks:

- firmer
- glossier
- more upright
- less stressed than the older leaves

That is one of the better signs you can get on a struggling phal, because the plant protects new growth last. If the newest leaf still looks decent, the core is still functioning.

So I'd read Bungalow Bill like this:

- older leaves show the history of stress
- newest leaf suggests he is still alive and trying to recover
- root system is probably weak, but not gone

That does not mean he is out of the woods, but it does mean I would lean a little more optimistic than pessimistic right now.

The next best sign would be a fresh root tip.

Sunday 9:38 AM



7/05/26

Thought for 5s >

Bungalow Bill still looks stressed, but the good news is I also see a reason to be encouraged.

Best sign in these photos:

- there are **fresh green root tips** showing in the pot

That matters a lot. New root tips mean he is not just hanging on — he is actively trying to recover.

What I'm seeing overall:

- newest/inner leaf still looks better than the older ones
- older leaves are still droopy and carry the old damage/stress
- crown looks intact from these angles
- the marked leaf spot/damage looks more like old damage than a fast-moving disaster
- root growth is the headline here

My read:

- **still weak, but improving underneath**
- top growth has not caught up yet, so the plant still looks rough
- recovery is going to be slow because orchids do that, especially rescues

What I'd do:

- keep watering thoroughly when the mix gets close to dry
- do not let it stay bone dry long
- keep bright indirect light
- do not repot again
- do not cut healthy leaves just because they droop

Important note:

Those old floppy leaves may never stand back up much. What matters more now is:

- new root tips
- a healthy center
- eventually a stronger new leaf

So for 7/5, I'd log Bungalow Bill as:

Bungalow Bill — 7/5/26

- still dehydrated-looking in older leaves
- crown intact
- fresh green root tips visible
- recovery in progress, slow but real

That new root activity is exactly what you wanted to see.

The top 2 leaves are firm. The bottom 2 have been droopy since the day I rescued it

Thought for a couple of seconds >

That fits what I'm seeing.

If the top 2 leaves are firm, that's a good sign. It usually means:

- the core is still functioning
- the plant is supporting newer tissue
- the current root activity is enough to keep the newest growth going

And if the bottom 2 have been droopy since rescue day, they're probably just the old "history leaves." Those often do not fully recover, even if the orchid survives and improves.

So I'd judge Bungalow Bill mostly by:

- the firmness of the newest leaves
- new root tips
- whether the center stays healthy

Not by whether those oldest leaves ever perk back up.

At this point, I'd call that encouraging. He may stay cosmetically wonky for a while, but if the top leaves stay firm and roots keep growing, he's moving in the right direction.